

FREE PATTERN

Free Mini Amigurumi Ball Pattern for Beginners

A small taste of amigurumi shaping — increases, decreases, and stuffing — without committing to a full toy.

Updated 2026 • US terms • About 1.5in / 4cm finished diameter



This is the fifth project from our [easiest first projects guide](#), written out row by row. It covers the two shaping moves used in almost every amigurumi pattern — increasing to grow the round, then decreasing to close it — on a shape simple enough to finish in one sitting.

MATERIALS

- Small amount of worsted-weight yarn (under 20 yards)
- 3.5mm hook (smaller than standard, for tight amigurumi stitches)
- A pinch of polyester fiberfill stuffing
- Stitch marker, to track the start of each round
- Scissors
- Yarn needle, for closing and weaving in ends

ABBREVIATIONS (US TERMS)

ABBR .	MEANS
sc	Single crochet
st(s)	Stitch(es)
inc	2 sc in same stitch (increase)
dec	Sc 2 sts together (decrease)
rnd(s)	Round(s)

See our [abbreviations glossary](#) for the full list including UK terms.

GAUGE

Gauge isn't critical for this small project — the goal is a tight, even fabric that hides the stuffing rather than an exact measurement. If you can see stuffing through your stitches, try a smaller hook.

NOTES

- Written in US terms and worked in a continuous spiral, same technique covered in our [amigurumi for beginners guide](#).
- Use a smaller hook than you'd normally pair with this yarn weight — tight stitches are what keep the stuffing from showing through.
- Stuff gradually while closing the final rounds, not all at once at the end — it keeps the shape rounder.

Pattern

ROUND 1

Make a magic ring, 6 sc into ring, place marker. (6 sts)

ROUND 2

Inc in every st around. (12 sts)

ROUND 3

[sc 1, inc] around. (18 sts)

ROUNDS 4–6

Sc in every st around, no increases or decreases. (18 sts each round)

ROUND 7

[sc 1, dec] around. (12 sts)

Begin adding a small amount of stuffing now, before the opening gets too small.

ROUND 8

Dec in every st around. (6 sts)

Add a bit more stuffing if needed to fill the shape evenly.

FINISHING

Fasten off, leaving a long tail. Thread the tail through the front loop of each remaining stitch, pull tight to close the opening, and weave in the end through the centre of the ball.

Frequently asked questions

How much stuffing does a mini amigurumi ball need?

A ball this size uses roughly a golf-ball-sized amount of polyester fiberfill, added gradually as you close the final rounds so the shape stays round rather than lumpy.

Can I make this amigurumi ball bigger?

Yes, add one more increase round after round 3 and one more decrease round before closing to scale it up, keeping the stitch counts symmetrical between the increase and decrease halves.

Why does my amigurumi ball look lumpy instead of round?

Lumpy shaping usually means the stuffing was added unevenly or in clumps rather than small pieces spread throughout. Stuff gradually as you close the final rounds, checking the shape with your fingers as you go.

Written by Emily Hartwell

Emily has been crocheting for over a decade, ever since her grandmother taught her the basics one summer. She started CrochetGuides to write the clear, honest, beginner-friendly instructions she wishes she'd had when she was learning — the ones that actually work the first time.